# Whose Question Is It?

Questions for your wife, for each of the kids, and the ones to save for a professional, with room to write what each person says.

Some questions about the future are your wife's to answer and nobody else's. Some belong to the kids, and a couple are yours. A few can't be answered at the kitchen table at all, and those are worth saving instead of guessing at.

This guide sorts fifteen questions by who can answer them. It doesn't answer any of them, and it doesn't rank them. Ask them as they are, over as many conversations as it takes, and write what each person says under the question.

## Your wife

These are hers to answer, in her own time. Begin by asking whether she'd like to talk at all, and after that follow her lead.

1. Would you be willing to talk sometime about what you'd want in the years ahead? It doesn't have to be today.

2. What does a good day look like for you?

3. What matters most to you about the way you live now?

4. Which routines and choices would you most want to keep, whatever else changes?

5. Who would you want to be part of a conversation like this, and who not yet?

6. When would you like to come back to this?

## Each of the kids, and anyone else who would be involved

Ask each person on their own if you can, so nobody answers for anyone else. In these questions, “she” and “her” mean your wife.

1. What do you hope for her in the years ahead, and what concerns you?

2. What do you think she would want, and is that something she's told you or something you've gathered?

3. If she ever needed more help, what could you realistically offer, and how often?

4. What couldn't you do?

5. What would your answer depend on: your job, the distance, your own health, your own family?

## Yourself

1. What do I want for her, and how much of that has she actually said?

2. What could I honestly do myself, and what am I assuming the kids would do?

## Her doctor, or another clinician

Now and then a question about health will come up that nobody in the family can answer. Write it down the way it came up and keep it for one of her regular visits. Whether to raise it, and whether you're in the room, is up to her.

1. A question came up when we talked about the future, and none of us could answer it: _____. Is that one for you, or for someone else?

## Your care consultant

Someone who asks your wife directly what is important to her, and keeps her wishes separate from the family's.

1. Here is what she told us she wants to keep, and what each of us said we could offer. What else would you want to ask her, and us?

**What this guide doesn't do**

It doesn't answer these questions, and it doesn't say which one matters most. If someone would rather not answer one, leave the lines under it empty. An empty line is information too, and it's theirs to fill in later.

## Ready for the next step?

You've sorted the questions by whose they are, and some of them now have answers. The care interview gives those answers somewhere to go: it walks through your wife's situation area by area and turns what you enter into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

**Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›**

### WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Keeping a written list of questions for a doctor's visit, and leaving the answers to the person whose visit it is, follows the National Institute on Aging's tips for caregivers. The questions themselves, and the sorting by who answers, are the Family Care Roadmap's own.

1. National Institute on Aging, Taking Someone to a Doctor's Appointment: Tips for Caregivers

---